

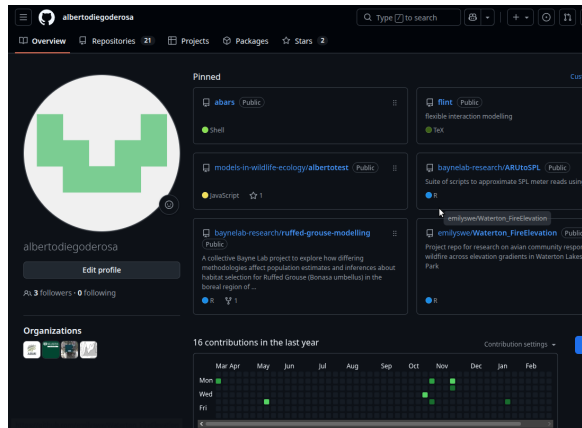
GITHUB AND US: PAGES

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24th March 2026

GitHub: what it is

- GitHub is a platform built around **Git**, a version control system.
- It helps you track changes, collaborate, and keep a record of your work.
- Useful for:
 - code
 - manuscripts
 - websites
 - data analysis workflows
- It can fit into wider research workflows with tools such as:
 - Google Colab
 - Overleaf
 - OSF



Researchers and online presence

The screenshot shows the ResearchGate website interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'ResearchGate', 'Home', 'Questions', and 'Jobs' links. A search bar is present with the placeholder text 'Search for research, journals, people, etc.'. To the right of the search bar are icons for notifications, email, and a chat bubble, followed by a user profile picture and an 'Add new' button. The main content area features a profile card for 'Cristian Pérez Granados' who has 'added research'. The card includes a profile picture, a dropdown arrow, and a preview of a research paper titled 'TABMON - real-time acoustic biodiversity monitoring across Europe'. The paper is marked as a 'Preprint' from 'January 2026' with '184 Reads' and lists authors: Benjamin Cretois, Carolyn Rosten, Julia Wiel, and Sarab Sethi. To the right of the profile card is a section titled 'Jobs you may be interested in'. It lists two jobs: 'Postdoctoral position at NIH - Malaria Parasite Structural and Molecular Biology' (marked as a 'New job') and 'Experimental Project Manager' (marked as 'Expires in 5 days'). Logos for the National Institute of Allergy and Infectious Diseases and the University of Cambridge are visible next to the job listings.

We are visible across several platforms:

- university directory page
- ORCID
- Google Scholar
- ResearchGate

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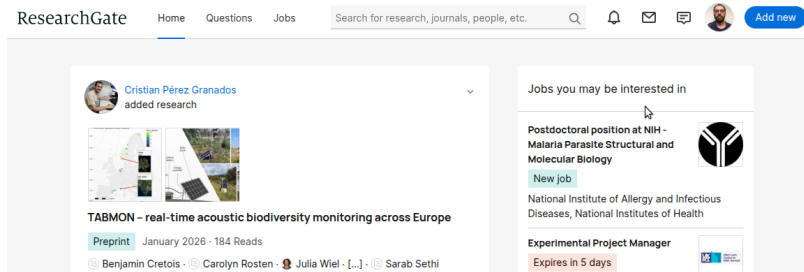
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These serve different purposes:

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- publications
- institutional affiliation
- contact details

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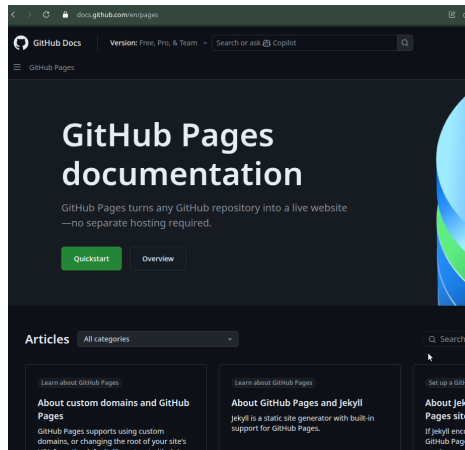
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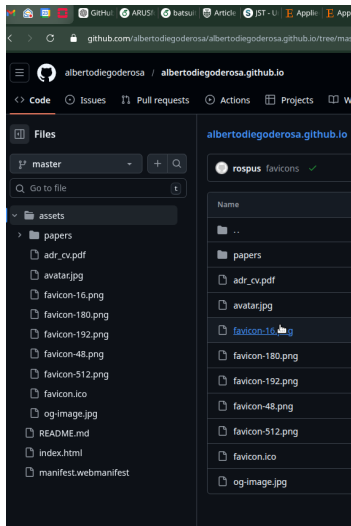
A personal site can bring these together in one place.

What is GitHub Pages?

- GitHub Pages is GitHub's **static** website hosting service.
- It publishes a website from files in a repository.
- Typical ingredients:
 - HTML
 - CSS
 - JavaScript
 - optionally a site generator such as Jekyll or Quarto
- Two common cases:
 - **User site:** `username.github.io`
 - **Project site:** a site attached to a normal repository



How to enable GitHub Pages



User site

- Create a repository named `username.github.io`
- Push website files to it
- Enable publishing in repository settings if needed

Project site

- A normal repository can also become a Pages site
- In Settings > Pages, choose the publishing source
- This may be a branch/folder or a GitHub Actions workflow

Take-home point

- `username.github.io` is the special *user site*
- GitHub Pages is broader than that

Example: my own page

What I include

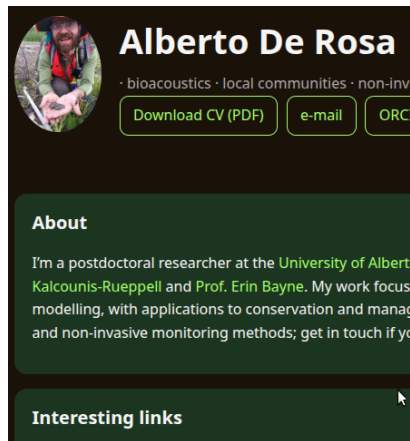
- links to ORCID, Google Scholar, GitHub
- short profile
- interesting links
- research interests
- contact information

What I do not include

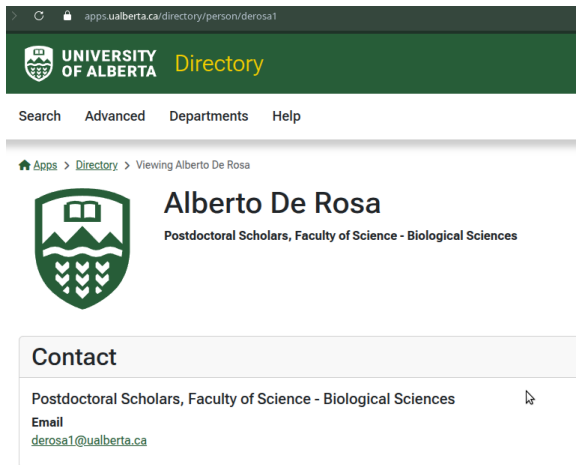
- personal information
- embargoed manuscripts
- every project in full detail

Aim

- clear, professional, easy to update



One simple message



The screenshot shows a web browser at the URL `apps.ualberta.ca/directory/person/derosa1`. The page header features the University of Alberta logo and the word "Directory" in yellow. Below the header is a navigation bar with links: Search, Advanced, Departments, and Help. The main content area shows a breadcrumb trail: `Apps > Directory > Viewing Alberto De Rosa`. Below this is a green shield-shaped logo with a book and mountains. To the right of the logo, the name "Alberto De Rosa" is displayed in large black text, followed by "Postdoctoral Scholars, Faculty of Science - Biological Sciences" in smaller black text. A "Contact" section is visible at the bottom, containing the text "Postdoctoral Scholars, Faculty of Science - Biological Sciences" and "Email derosa1@ualberta.ca".

Summary

GitHub helps you manage work.

GitHub Pages helps you present it, and yourself.

- Good for a simple academic web presence
- Easy to revise through the same repository workflow
- Useful as a central hub linking your other profiles